

Security Guard Interview Protocol

Standalone extract of the Phase 1 report

CSE 347/652 | DES 306/525 Usable Security and Privacy
IIIT-Delhi · Monsoon 2026 · Instructor: Dr. Arun Balaji Buduru

Phase 1: User Studies to evolve Requirements, Design and Workflows
Submission: 4 October 2026

Team: [INSERT TEAM MEMBER NAMES AND ROLL NUMBERS]

Primary research status: instruments complete; fieldwork data not yet collected. All placeholders are marked [DATA REQUIRED]. No primary data has been fabricated.

Appendix B. Security Guard Interview Protocol

Format: Semi-structured, 20–30 minutes, one interviewer and one note-taker. Conducted off-shift or during a quiet period, with permission from the security supervisor. Language: Hindi or English as the participant prefers; the protocol should be translated verbally where needed and the translation noted.

B.1 Introduction (read aloud)

Namaste / Hello. Thank you for speaking with us. We are students in a course on usable security at IIIT-Delhi. We are studying how campus entry works so that any future system is designed around the people who actually operate it. We want to learn from your experience; there are no right or wrong answers, and we are not evaluating you or your work. This will take about 20–30 minutes.

B.2 Consent statement (read aloud; see also Appendix C)

Your participation is voluntary. You can skip any question or stop at any time, and this will have no effect on your job. We will not record your name, employee ID, or which gate you work at in our report. We will take written notes. We will only record audio if you say yes, and we will delete the audio after we write it up. What you tell us will be combined with what other guards tell us and reported as a group, so no one can be identified. Do you agree to take part? [Record: Yes / No]
May we record audio? [Yes / No]

B.3 Core questions

#	Question	Topic	Follow-up probes
Q1	Can you walk me through what you do when a student comes to the gate, from the moment you see them to when they're through?	Current workflow	What do you look at first? How long does it usually take? Does it differ at the vehicle gate?
Q2	How do you decide the ID is genuine?	Verification	What features do you look for? Have you seen cards that looked wrong? What did you do?
Q3	How often do you recognise students by face rather than checking the card?	Verification / workaround	Is that more common at certain times? Do you feel that is reliable?
Q4	Do you check the validity or expiry date on the card?	Expiry	How easy is it to read? What happens if it's expired?
Q5	What do you do if the photo doesn't seem to match the person, or the card looks suspicious?	Suspicious / fake IDs	Who do you call? How long does it take? How often does this happen?
Q6	What happens when a student arrives without an ID card?	Forgotten ID	Is there a set procedure? Does it vary by guard or shift? What do students usually say?
Q7	If a student has lost their card, how would you know if someone else is using it?	Lost / stolen	Is there any list or notice you receive?
Q8	Tell me about the busiest times. What changes in how you check?	Busy periods / delays	How long do queues get? Do you ever have to speed up checks? What would help most at those times?
Q9	How do you handle visitors?	Visitors	What information do you write down? Who checks it? What happens with the register afterwards? What is hardest about visitors?
Q10	Have you used any electronic device or system at a gate here or elsewhere, e.g., a card reader, scanner, or tablet? What was your experience?	Device / network	What went wrong? What happened when the device or network failed? Was there a fallback?
Q11	If a screen showed you information about the person at the gate, what would you need to see to make a confident decision?	Information needed	Photo? Name? Roll number? Department? Hostel? Anything else?
Q12	Is there information about students that you think should not be shown to you, or that you'd be uncomfortable being responsible for?	Privacy	Phone numbers? Addresses? Why?
Q13	What training did you receive for gate duty, and how long did it take to feel confident?	Training	What would a new guard find hardest?
Q14	If you could change one thing about how entry works, what would it be?	Desired features	Why? What would you be worried about with an electronic system?

B.4 Additional questions for security office / ID cell (if accessible)

#	Question
A1	How is a new ID card issued? What documents and approvals are needed, and how long does it take?
A2	What happens when a student reports a lost or stolen card? Is the old card blocked anywhere?
A3	How are cards handled when a student graduates, withdraws, or is suspended?
A4	Who approves visitors, and how is the approval communicated to the gate?
A5	Are there areas or times with restricted access? How is that enforced today?
A6	If there is an incident (theft, intrusion), what records do you have to investigate who was on campus?
A7	Who would have administrative access to an electronic entry system, and what controls would you expect on that access?

B.5 Closing

Thank you. Is there anything you'd like to add or anything you'd prefer we not include? If you think of something later, here is how to reach us: [TEAM CONTACT].

B.6 Notes template (one per interview)

Interview code: G__ Date: ____ Duration: ____ min
 Interviewer: ____ Note-taker: ____
 Shift type (morning/afternoon/night): ____ Gate type (pedestrian/vehicle/both): ____
 Years of experience at this campus (approx.): ____ Audio consent: Y / N

 Q1 Workflow:
 Q2 Genuine check:
 Q3 Face recognition:
 Q4 Expiry:
 Q5 Suspicious ID:
 Q6 Forgotten ID:
 Q7 Lost card:
 Q8 Busy periods:
 Q9 Visitors:
 Q10 Devices/network:
 Q11 Info needed:
 Q12 Info NOT to show:
 Q13 Training:
 Q14 One change / worries:

Verbatim quotes worth keeping (mark with ") :
 Observed emotions / emphasis:
 Contradictions with observation or other interviews:
 Follow-up needed: